

book/tablet computers, Personal Digital Assistants (PDAs), voice over Internet protocol (VoIP) phones and other Wi-Fi enabled equipment as organizations and individuals recognize their flexibility and value.

6. Economies of scale are rapidly driving down price points for Wi-Fi equipment, which will continue to decrease as annual shipments of 802.11 radios grow from 70+ million units in 2004 to 125+ million units in 2008 (*Source: IDC*). For example, an 802.11 NIC can be purchased for less than \$25, a low-end Access Point (AP) for less than \$60 and a full-featured enterprise class AP for about \$500. Clearly, 802.11 is becoming the wireless equivalent of the wired Ethernet.
7. The ability to add new services such as “location awareness” to the standard 802.11 infrastructure. This will deliver additional ROI by enabling active RFID capabilities such as tracking of people and assets, and delivery of location-aware content to devices such as PDAs and tablet computers. Providing enterprises extended visibility into their mission-critical assets can drive significant cost savings and efficiencies.

Considering the drivers outlined above, most organizations are now rapidly replacing various point wireless solutions with a single wireless network based on 802.11 technologies to provide their mobile workforce un-tethered access to both voice and data services. As enterprises commence these deployments, they are realizing that their existing 802.11 infrastructure can also be used to solve one of their biggest headaches-locating valuable assets.

The Emergence Of Location-Aware Applications

Keeping track of valuable equipment across large facilities with hundreds or thousands of IT assets (i.e., servers, notebooks, PC's, PDA's, software) used by thousands of employees is a daunting task. Some estimates claim that more than 2,000 computers are